

Main

Report Name (Org_Country_Year_Report Type)

Kakenya's Dream_Kenya_2022-23_3-month report

Fellowship Organization

Kakenya's Dream

Fellowship City

Enosaen/Isampin, Kenya

Fellowship Country

Kenya

Fellowship Start Date

08/29/2022

Anticipated Fellowship End Date

08/29/2023

What is your fellowship title/role?

I am an Education Program Officer

What are your primary responsibilities?

The following are my primary responsibilities:

Curriculum Development:

Develop a written curriculum/plan for each grade level that builds upon the current government curriculum and results in our students being more competitive at the international level

Assess and compare the current government curriculum against those of international standards for each grade level

Propose and build out content related to weakness identified with an eye to how new content can be integrated into the government curriculum

Identify and build out content for soft skills that each student should achieve by each grade level

Identify additional benchmarks and other metrics beyond just grades to evaluate the success of each topic/grade level, that can be maintained by teachers and administration in the future

Work in collaboration with your colleagues and the administration to gain input and buy-in to the proposed curriculum changes

Curriculum Implementation :

Assist teachers with building out lesson plans and materials to support the new curriculum

Assist the teachers with implementing more student-centered learning techniques into their teaching

Assist the administration with evaluating teacher performance and working to address weaknesses

Revise the curriculum as needed based on lessons

I receive adequate direction and support to perform my fellowship responsibilities.

Strongly Agree

Did you receive any sort of orientation, handover or onboarding when you started your fellowship?

Yes

Please describe your orientation/onboarding and note who handled it.

I had a virtual orientation each week for a month, on Zoom before I arrived in Kenya. Additionally, once, I made it to Kenya, I had more onboarding

If you did not receive any kind of orientation, what information or guidance were you provided at the start of your fellowship?
Describe a representative day at work.

I generally work on Monday through Friday from 9 AM to 5 PM. Sometimes, I work on the weekends for special events

My typical work day consists of coming into my office, working from my office provided laptop, and conducting research on the government curriculum in Kenya. Additionally, I look at international examples of curriculum and develop a document to build out an internal curriculum for my organization

On average, how many hours per week do you work?

40-45 hours/week

How would you describe your effectiveness in your fellowship post so far?

Neutral

Please briefly describe 1-2 specific projects that you have undertaken or accomplishments you have made so far.

One project I am working on is developing an internal curriculum that focuses on soft skills and reinforcing information from the Kenyan government. The internal curriculum I am working on compares international examples of curricula, the Kenyan government's curriculum, and my organization's curriculum. Another project I am working on is developing an internal assessment test for students entering primary school at my organization.

What is your organization's work culture like?
What is your office environment like? Please comment on the size and structure of the office(s) where you do most of your work.

My office environment is pretty standard. I work in a small office with 12 employees. Everyone in the office has their own desk, however, only 2 people have an office. Everyone else is relatively squeezed together throughout the office in their respective desks. Every employee has their own company-provided laptop to do their work

To whom do you report?

I report to 2 people, and I would classify them both as my supervisors— one is a local (Kenyan supervisor) and another is my supervisor from the U.S.

Have you had an initial check-in with your supervisor to set up a work plan and to set goals for your work during your fellowship year?

Yes

Was this meeting helpful in understanding your role and setting goals for your fellowship year?

Yes, it was very helpful.

Please explain why you have not met with your supervisor and if you have plans to do so going forward.**Please briefly indicate 3-5 professional goals you have for the rest of your fellowship year. Your professional goals should align with your work plan.**

By February 2023, I want to finish developing an internal assessment for Grade 4 students

By March 2023, I want to finish developing the internal curriculum, so that I can begin implementing the new curriculum

By mid-March 2023, I want to work with teachers and administration to begin implementing the new curriculum

How often do you check in with your supervisor?

Weekly

Have you had an opportunity to travel for work so far?

No

Describe this travel opportunity. Include location(s) and a brief description of the purpose of the trip(s).**I feel adequately prepared for my position's professional responsibilities.**

Agree

Please briefly explain your response.

I have been given all my responsibilities and periodically have meetings with my supervisors to discuss my roles and responsibilities.

Life at Fellowship Site

How did you travel to your host country and site? Please be specific

I purchased my ticket from the United Airlines website. I flew on United Airlines from MCO to Newark, New Jersey, New Jersey to Germany, Germany to Ethiopia, Ethiopia to Nairobi. I bought a one way ticket and it costs \$959.40.

What kind of visa/ permit do you have or applied for?

The visa I have is a student visa.

How did you obtain (or are obtaining) your visa or permit?

I obtained my visa from my host organization. They applied for me and paid for it.

Did you apply for and receive your visa / permit before heading to your host country or after arriving?

Yes, I received my visa before heading to my host country

What costs were associated with obtaining your visa or permit?

I only paid for my police fingerprints before obtaining my visa

Did you pay the visa / permit costs or were they covered by your organization?

The costs were covered by my organization

Are you still having challenges obtaining your visa/ permit?

No

If yes, please explain further

g) Do you have any suggestions to help future Fellows navigate the visa / permit application process?

I would suggest asking your host organization for assistance

What vaccinations were you required to obtain prior to your departure? How much did your vaccinations cost? Did you get a yellow fever vaccination?

I was not required to get any vaccines, except the COVID-19 vaccine, but I had already been vaccinated

I chose to get the yellow fever vaccine, the typhoid vaccine, the Hep A vaccine, the adult polio vaccine, and adult tetanus. I paid around \$300 for the yellow fever vaccine and my insurance covered most of the other vaccines

How was your arrival and first week in your host country? Any improvements that could streamline the assimilation process for future Fellows?

My first week in my host country was tough because a few days after arriving, I had to start work when my body was still adjusting to the time zone. If I could go back, I would have arrived a week earlier to explore. Nairobi and adjust to being in Kenya and then go to work. I needed more time before I went to my village

Is housing provided by and/or paid for by your organization? Please explain.

Housing is provided by my host organization. I live on campus at the boarding school. I live in the staff quarters of the campus.

Do you live in a location that is more urban or rural?

Very Rural

Please describe your living environment

I live in a rural area with no running water. I live in an apartment." I have my own room with a bed, "kitchen" area, a shower room, a desk, and a wardrobe— all of these were provided by my host organization. My host organization provided me with a gas cooker, pots, pans, and some eating utensils along with a small kitchen cupboard. There are some latrines located near my apartment to use.

How do you typically travel between your home and your work? How much does your daily transportation cost and how long is your commute?

Since I live where I work, I walk to my office. It is a 1 minute walk. My daily transportation doesn't cost me anything.

If you live in a more rural area, what are the closest urban areas you can travel to for shopping, airport, larger medical centers, etc.?

The closest urban area for shopping and medical centers is about an hour and half to 2 hours away depending on traffic and weather conditions. The nearest airport is about 3 hours away in the Maasai Mara. Depending on the form of transportation you take, the price of travel can vary from \$20 to over \$100 per trip.

How is the weather in your host country? What season are you presently in?

Since I am in an elevated rural area, it rains often and gets very cold in the morning and evenings. I believe I am currently in the beginning of summer

What is the appropriate clothing for work and outside of work at your fellowship post and in your community in general?

The appropriate clothing for my work ranges from business casual to business professional. Appropriate clothing for outside work consists of bottoms that are not above the knees and tops that cover your chest and shoulders. Typically, the style of dress here is more conservative.

How have you been spending your free time?

Most of my free time is spent reading books or watching tv/film in my room. There are not many opportunities for socializing in my site, since the area is so rural

I've been able to successfully navigate my personal/social life both back at home and at my fellowship post.

Disagree

Please briefly explain your response below.

I have not had any issues navigating my personal/social life back home. However, I have had issues navigating my personal/social life at my fellowship post. I want more time to explore Kenya. However, the distance from my village to other tourist areas is relatively far.

Would you say you live and work in a safe area?

Yes, I would say I live and work in a safe area. The campus I live and work at has security guards. I am not aware of any crime issues in my area of work and residence.

What precautions do you take to ensure your safety?

I make sure to ask my colleagues about any location I am thinking of traveling too. Additionally, I try not to travel alone and make sure to alert my colleagues when I am traveling some place

What has been your experience with crime so far? (Please note that any security or safety concerns or incidents should be reported directly to PiAf staff per PiAf safety and security protocol.)

I have not had any experience with crime thus far

Describe the incidence of crime and the general security situation within your city/town. Could you recommend specific areas future Fellows might consider for safe housing? What about areas that should be avoided?

I cannot describe any incidence of crime in my village. I feel safe on the compound I live on because I live at a boarding school with security guards. I do not have any recommendations for future Fellows for safe housing because their housing will be provided to them by their host organization. I do not know what areas should be avoided.

Please refer back to the goals you set for yourself before orientation. Are you working towards these goals? Have you met any of them? Changed any of them? Please explain.

Yes, I am working toward those goals I set for myself. I have met one of my goals. I have changed one of my goals: I want to be a beginner level speaker in Swahili as opposed to an intermediate level

Do you have any frustrations with your living arrangements, your work or your life outside of work?

I think the one frustration I have with my living environment is adjusting to not having consistent access to a toilet. However, I am adjusting. Another frustration I have to my life outside of work is that I do not always have consistent access to transportation

Has there been anything that you have needed but have not been able to locate or acquire?

There are certain food items, which is expected, that I have not been able to locate or acquire near my village.

How have you dealt with "culture shock"?

I have dealt with culture shock by reflecting via journaling and having conversations with locals and my friends and family back home.

What about your experience thus far has been the most...surprising?

Thus far, the most surprising part of my experience has been me getting sick often. I did not expect to get sick as often as I have.

What about your experience thus far has been the most...challenging?

The most challenging part of my experience thus far is not really having the time to have a social life. The travel time to places to have fun are very far from my village and make it hard for me to really travel and explore Kenya

What are the top 3 things you miss the most from your home country or the U.S.?

1. Having access to transportation
2. Traveling/Exploring
3. Having a variety of events and activities to do for fun

What are the top 3 things about life in your host country that beat out life in your home country or the U.S.?

1. Healthy, fresh food (in the rural areas)
2. The scenery
3. Community oriented culture

How is your stipend being paid?

- A) My stipend is being paid monthly
- B) in U.S. dollars
- C)U.S. account

How are you receiving your stipend funds?

Wire

Did you raise funds to cover part of your fellowship expenses?

Yes, I raised funds amongst my family and friends to help cover part of my fellowship expense. I have NOT taken on any additional work during my fellowship year.

Please list any additional one-time or infrequent expenses not included in your monthly budget below.

Monthly Budget

Rent	Utilities	Furnishings	Phone	Home Security	Internet
\$0.00	\$0.00	\$30.00	\$20.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
Transportation	Fitness	Entertainment	Groceries	House Cleaning	Eating Out
\$200.00	\$0.00	\$40.00	\$100.00	\$20.00	\$75.00
Medications	Additional Health Insurance	Travel	Laundry	Other	Total Monthly Budget (Minus Entertainment & Travel)
\$50.00	\$0.00	\$200.00	\$20.00	\$0.00	485.00
Specify "Other"					

Final Thoughts

PiAf's orientation was sufficient in preparing me to transition into my fellowship.

Agree

Please briefly explain your response about Orientation.

Although I attended the pre-departure Orientation via zoom, it was sufficient in preparing me with the resources and materials I needed to move to Kenya

Is there anything in particular that PiAf could cover at orientation that would have better prepared you for your fellowship post? Please specify.

I think PiAf could have held a session about how to negotiate one's stipend

As we plan the upcoming PiAf Retreat, we hope to incorporate some Fellow suggestions into our programming. What are some topics or sessions you would like to see at the Retreat? (We appreciate your feedback however, we may not be able to accommodate all suggestions or requests this year.)

I would like to have a session where we talk about ways to enhance our fellowship through travel, exploration, or event staycations.

I would like to have a breakout session for those who identify as members of the African Diaspora, so that we can talk about our experiences.